

Updating the package is done using the following command :

yum update package

yum update will look for newer versions of the software and installs only if a newer version is detected.

Updating all packages listed in yum

yum update

This must be the most powerful command in yum! This command updates all the installed packages on the system to the latest version on your as specified in your repository.

Removing A Package From The System

When removing a package yum is programmed to remove all packages that depend on it. This is to ensure the system runs stably without facing dependency issues. You have to be very careful hence in removing packages. If the package that you are removing is something on which critical system processes, or say even X, depends on, you will have unknowingly removed the GUI from your Linux box! So be absolutely sure of what you are removing. The command to remove a package is

yum remove <package>

Editing The yum.conf File

You can use the *vi* editor to view the .conf files in Linux. When you open the yum.conf file, right in the beginning you will see options under *[main]*. For example you will see a setting called “*cachedir=*”. This is where you can change the cache directory (like a temporary directory to store files during download or install).

Lets take another example, there is a setting used to specify the number of retries after which yum gives up acquiring the package. It is defined in the setting “*retries=*”. You can specify the number of tries here. You can insert a “*throttle=*” setting and specify the maximum download speed for yum so that when you are downloading huge packages, your other downloads are not affected.